G.R Terry has defined filing as "the placing of documents and papers in acceptable containers of document and paper in acceptable containers according to some predetermined arrangement so that any of these may be located quickly and conveniently, when required".

According to **Zane K. Quible,** "Filing is one of the activities in the records management programme which involves systematically classifying, coding, arranging and placing of records in storage".

5.4.1. Advantages of Filing:

Records are stored under a suitable system of filing in order to achieve the following purposes and benefits.

1. Ready Reference:

Records constitute the storehouse of information relating to past events. They can be referred conveniently if they are filed in a systematic manner and a proper index is maintained for various files.

2. Safety of Records:

Filing ensures the safe storage of records of different types. Letters and other documents are put into folders and the folders are kept in cabinets. Thus records are saved from unforeseen happenings like theft fine etc.

3. Documentary Proof:

Records serve as documentary evidence in case of disputes. Copies of records can be produced to settle the claims with different parties. Records can also be produced in a court of law as evidence when a party to the dispute resorts to the process.

4. Prompt Handling of Correspondence:

Filing enables the handling of correspondence properly without any delay. It builds up the reputation of the organization and helps in securing orders.

5. Statutory Requirements:

Records are kept in compliance with provisions of various statutes like companies Act, Income tax Act, Factories Act, etc

6. Barometer of Progress:

Filing makes available the records of previous years. It helps in comparing the current year's performance with the previous years. Thus it is an important aid in measuring the efficiency of the enterprise and various departments.

7. Decision Making and Policy Formulation:

Availability of up-to-date information is essential for taking important decisions and for formulating policies. The degree of risk is increased if to decisions are based on relevant facts and figures.

8. Increased Efficiency:

Filing increased the efficiency of the office. It makes available to the management the required information with speed and

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